

AUGUST 2026

WEEK 1

UNDERSTANDING GOD'S REWARD SYSTEM

TEXT: *Hebrews 11:6*

INTRODUCTION: One of the greatest truths revealed throughout Scripture is that God is a Rewarder. He delights in blessing those who trust Him, obey His Word, and remain faithful in their walk with Him. God's rewards are not based on human manipulation or merit alone, but on His righteous nature, gracious promises, and covenant relationship with His children. The world often rewards status, popularity, wealth, or personal achievement, while God looks at the heart, motives, obedience, faithfulness, and perseverance **1 Sam. 16:7; Matt. 6:1–6**. Sometimes His rewards are immediate, while at other times they unfold over seasons or are reserved for eternity.

As believers, understanding God's reward system helps us remain steadfast even when our labour seems unnoticed. It gives us confidence that every act of obedience, sacrifice, service, generosity, and faithfulness done for the Lord is seen by Him and will never go unrewarded **1 Cor. 15:58**.

WHAT GOD'S REWARD SYSTEM REVEALS

1. **God Is a Rewarder by His Nature:** God does not merely give rewards occasionally; rewarding faithfulness is part of His character. **Heb. 11:6** declares that He rewards those who diligently seek Him. Abraham experienced God's reward through obedience **Gen. 22:15–18**, while Solomon received wisdom, riches and honour because his request pleased the Lord **1 Kgs. 3:10–13**. Since God never changes **Mal. 3:6**, believers today can confidently serve Him knowing that every act of genuine faith and obedience will be rewarded in His perfect time.
2. **God Rewards According to His Righteous Standards:** God's reward system is based on righteousness rather than outward appearance or human recognition. While people judge what they see, God examines the heart and the motives behind every action **1 Sam. 16:7**. Jesus taught that giving, praying, and fasting done to impress others receive only human applause, but those done sincerely before God receive His reward **Matt. 6:1–6, 16–18**. Therefore, believers should seek God's approval above man's, knowing that He faithfully rewards obedience, sincerity, and faithfulness **Rom. 2:6–7**.
3. **God's Rewards Are Both Earthly and Eternal:** God blesses His people not only with eternal rewards but also with blessings in this present life. As we obey Him, He grants favour, wisdom, provision, peace, protection, and fruitfulness **Deut. 28:1–14; Psm. 84:11**. At the same time, Jesus promised that those who sacrifice for His kingdom will receive blessings both now and in the life to come **Mk. 10:29–30**. Because God's greatest rewards extend into eternity **2 Cor. 4:17–18**, believers should remain faithful without becoming discouraged by temporary delays or earthly challenges.

4. **God Never Forgets Faithful Labour:** Every act of obedience and service rendered to God is remembered by Him. Although people may overlook our sacrifices, Scripture assures us that God is not unjust to forget our labour of love **Heb. 6:10**. Paul therefore encourages believers to work wholeheartedly because they serve the Lord Christ and will receive their reward from Him **Col. 3:23-24**. This truth gives believers confidence to remain faithful in serving God, knowing that no prayer, sacrifice, or act of love performed for His glory is ever wasted **1 Cor. 15:58**.
5. **The Greatest Reward Is God Himself:** While God blesses His children in many ways, His greatest reward is His own presence. Before promising Abraham numerous descendants, God declared, "I am your shield, your exceedingly great reward" **Gen. 15:1**. Jesus also taught that eternal life is found in knowing God personally **Jhn. 17:3**, while David testified that fullness of joy is found in His presence **Psm. 16:11**. As believers pursue God above His blessings, they discover that every other reward becomes meaningful because it flows from a living relationship with Him.